Historical source

Encyclopaedia Britannica scan, source row 2093. Parse 3.5 extracted the text. Super 3.5 VL corrected it from an enlarged crop of each block. It can still contain recognition errors. Page headers, footers, and page numbers are removed.

Untitled continuation (E0180)

Continues an entry from an earlier page.

S E N [151] S E N

Seules.

Theres _de terit-_ _meregé ahle._

we doubt the truth of such facts, we must at least ac- knowledge their probability, since we meet every day with a number of similar examples. When we see a chess-player so deeply immersed in thought as to be in a manner lost to his outward senses, should we not ima- gine him to be wholly engrossed with the care of his own private affairs, or of the public weal? but the ob- ject of all this profound meditation is the pleasure of ex- ercising the mind by the movement of a piece of ivory. From this exercise of the mind also arises the pleasure we sometimes take in refined and delicate sentiments, which, after the manner of Virgil's shepherds, (Et fugit ad salices, fed se cupit ante videri), are sometimes artfully concealed, but so as to afford us the pleasure of discovering them.

From some of the foregoing remarks we also feel that nature points out to us the superiority and excellence of our mental faculties, thus suggesting to us that we ought to cultivate them most, as being our better and our no- bler part, to the cultivation of which that of our sensi- tive faculties should be merely subservient. But, al- though our pleasures are thus by nature rendered in a great degree independent of ourselves, still we have it in our power to make them all more durable, by vary- ing and mixing them with one another, or by interpo- sing between those that are very agreeable others that are less pleasing, so as that no individual pleasure shall be in excess.

Besides the circumstances already noticed, there are others of a very different kind, which have also considerable influence on the pleasures of the senses ; such as different conditions of the whole body, particularly of the nerves, or of certain organs or functions, to which functions some organs of sense, and perhaps even the sensation of them, are in a great measure subservient. This is one of the causes why many pleasures, which we cultivate with all our might, cannot be immortal. If a person be thirsty, spring water is nectar to him ; if hungry, any kind of food is agreeable, even the smell of food is grateful. To a man in a heat, or in a fever, cold is pleasing ; and to one in a cold fit nothing is so agreeable as heat. To the same persons, at other times, so far are these things from being agreeable, that they are often disgusting. The most decided glutton cannot always relish a sumptuous feast.

Besides the sensations excited by external objects, there are others also which cause pain and pleasure. If the action of the muscles be strong, easy, and cheerful, and not continued so as to fatigue us, it causes pleasure. On the contrary, when this action is attended with a sense of littleness, inaptitude, difficulty, and debility, it causes pain more or less. In fine, various states and affections of the mind, such as the exercise of memory, imagination, and judgment, nearly for similar reasons, are sometimes painful, at other times agreeable. Animi affectus, qui modici grato excitant, vehementes, aut graves et diuturni, hujus pariter ac corporis vires frangunt; hominem intersum flatim extinguunt, fdus longa valetudine macerant. Somni etiam, quo ud exhaustas vires reficiendas egemus, excessus, vel defectus, et animo et corpori nocet.Defid. five animi five corporis, utrisque vires languentes: nimia exercitatione haud minus laeduntur. Statuit enim provida rerum parens, ut fingularum partium, et universi corporis animique vires usu roborentur et acuan-

tur ; et huic iterum certos fines posuit : ita ut neque quem voluit natura ufus impune omitatur, neque ultra modum intendatur *."

Of such sensations and feelings as are agreeable or disagreeable, we may remark, says Dr Reid, that they differ much, not only in degree, but in kind and in dignity. Some belong to the animal part of our nature, and are common to us with the brutes: others belong to the rational and moral part. The first are more properly called sensations, the last feelings. The French word sentiment is common to both.

The Authorized nature, in the distribution of agree- able and painful feelings, hair wisely and hencerevolently conducted the good of the few themes, which seem then us, by the means, which tensor of conduct we ought to hold. For, foly, The painful fematıons of the animal, kind and humanities to arxosh who would hurt us; and the agreeable femifications of this kind in- vice us to think actions that are according to the prefix- relation of the animals, or of the kind. Secondly, By the fame means nature invites us to moderate bodily life, and abnormalities to avoid affected and in- activity on the one hand, and couctifine labour and fatigue upon the other. Thirdly, The meanase ex-ce of all our national poverty gives practice. Pourishly, Every species of beauty is behold with pleasure, and it very forces of theonomy were digging and way final find all that we call beautiful, too, is something dima-

able, or useful in talk(), or a sign of formething that is eliminate a unfair. Fylility. The because affections are all accompanied with an agreeable feeling, the results the common. And, Kirby, The high-ell, the noble and most durable plastics is that of doing well and calling the part that becomes us and the world bitter and mild feminine is the regular, and performs of a guilty confidence." These observations will regard to the economy of women in the difficulties of our painful and agreeable fematıons and feelings are to dwell. Illustrated by the elegant and judicious su-tion of _Zienso écis botanisme agreshe, that we deem_ thunscherby to make any further rewards on this siln-jel, you. Haravess and Paracusary. A little re-action may faility us, and the member and lawyer of our fematıons and feelings are prodigious. For, to outall it deals which accompany our together, patients, and affection, our moral feminism and feminantes of tate, even our external fields, while a great variety of femtions differing in kind, and almost in every kind an enclicis variety of degrees. Every variety we discern, with regards to tute, family, family, female, born, and each, and in the timely qualities of bodies, is indicated by a feminate corresponding to it.

The most general and the most important division of our sensations and feelings is into the agreeable, the disagreeable, and the indifferent. Every thing we call pleasure, happiness, or enjoyment, on the one hand; and, on the other, every thing we call misery, pain, or uneasiness, is sensation or feeling: For no man can for the present be more happy, or more miserable, than he feels himself to be. He cannot be deceived with regard to the enjoyment or suffering of the present moment.

But, besides the sensations that are agreeable or disagreeable, there is still a greater number that are indifferent. To these we give so little attention, that they have no name, and are immediately forgotten as if they had

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